Kestrel underhood fuse box water intrusion can cause electrical short and los

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Area: recalls

1 Defect Description

On affected Kestrel vehicles, the underhood fuse box assembly (part FUSE-9980) uses a top seal that can degrade and allow water intrusion during heavy rain or high-pressure washing. Moisture pooling on the bus bars creates a low-resistance path that shorts adjacent circuits, and in many reported cases the body control module loses communication with the instrument cluster and logs DTC U0140. When this fault propagates across the network, drivers may experience sudden loss of exterior and interior lighting while the vehicle is in operation. Technicians can confirm the failure mode using the diagnostic guidance in the Vega Electrical Service Manual :: Lost Communication with BCM and Cluster , which describes the same U0140 signature, and cross-check harness routing against the Vega Electrical Service Manual :: Wiring Harness and Fuse Box . The Kestrel Electrical Service Manual and the broader Vega Electrical Service Manual :: Electrical System Overview provide the supporting circuit references for confirming the short.

2 Remedy

Dealers will replace the underhood fuse box (FUSE-9980) with a revised unit that incorporates an upgraded gasketed top seal and a drain channel to prevent water from collecting on the bus bars. After replacement, technicians must clear DTC U0140 and verify network integrity following the Vega Electrical Service Manual :: CAN Bus Communication Diagnosis Procedure before returning the vehicle to the customer. Any corroded harness branches discovered during inspection should be repaired per the Vega Electrical Service Manual :: Network and Harness Sub-System Service , and BCM functionality re-validated using the Vega Electrical Service Manual :: BCM Sub-System Service . This repair is performed at no charge to the owner. Owners can confirm whether their vehicle is included by entering their VIN at https://www.nhtsa.gov/recalls.